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DAYS OF RECKONING

The Mumbai attacks were the most successful terrorist spectacular since 9/11 and brought Lashkar-e-Taiba to the attention of the world. Yet the speed with which Lashkar was found culpable also led to heavy pressure on Pakistan to take action against the group, including: dismantle the militant infrastructure that made Mumbai possible; outlaw JuD, which was clearly the group's above-ground wing; and either extradite or take serious legal action against those involved in the plot. There was a flurry of initial activity in the weeks after Mumbai as the government and army took steps to show they were serious about cracking down on the group. The security services raided a Lashkar camp outside Muzaffarabad on 7 December 2008, the same day a journalist revealed Kasab's Pakistani origins. They took approximately ten to twenty members, including Zaki-ur Rehman Lakhvi, into custody and sealed the offices there.[1] This was the first concrete step taken against the group, but Pakistani officials took pains to avoid appearing as though they were acquiescing to Indian pressure and asserted the state would go at its own pace in terms of taking action against Lashkar.[2] Indeed, these initial raids took place even as Pakistani officials continued to deny that any of the country's citizens were involved in the Mumbai attacks.[3]

The UN Al-Qaeda and Taliban Sanctions Committee labeled JuD a front organization for Lashkar-e-Taiba and declared it a terrorist organization in early December. It also designated Lakhvi, Saeed, and two other top officials as terrorists subject to a freeze of assets, travel ban and arms embargo.[4] In response, the government promised to take 'consequential actions, as required, including the freezing of assets.'[5] Pakistan also sealed some JuD offices, ostensibly banned it from fundraising as well as